warnings, he did not rescind his approval to cross the parallel. On October 7, US forces crossed the parallel. Twelve days later, Chinese troops started moving into Korea.

Expectations in Washington that the Chinese entry into the war would lead India to see the light assumed that Delhi would share Washington's interpretation of Chinese actions. Instead, it increased Nehru's frustration with the US rather than with China. Indian officials believed MacArthur's move had provoked China into retaliation. This heightened the prospect of a larger war, which Nehru—dreading that India would be dragged into war at a time when it needed peace—had been trying to prevent.[204] To avert even further escalation, India sponsored a UN resolution in January 1951, backed by Britain, that called for a ceasefire and negotiations. The US grudgingly supported the resolution, with Acheson hoping that China would reject it.[205]

Beijing did exactly that, leading to criticism in Indian newspapers and disappointment in the government.[206] An Indian diplomat in Moscow reported back that Chinese "intransigence" was following "the Soviet line," and Delhi should thus curtail hopes of an "Asiatic Tito" (i.e., a Mao willing to buck that line).[207] But, publicly, the Indian government asserted that the Chinese reply was not an "outright rejection."[208]

Parallel American efforts toward a General Assembly resolution blaming China as the aggressor proved to be another source of tension between the US and India. Nehru vociferously criticized it as another example of the US not facing facts. He argued that rather than Chinese aggression being responsible, "All the troubles in the Far East arise from the failure of the rest of the world to adjust itself to the changes which have taken place in Asia."[209] For Nehru, the US had erred in crossing the 38th parallel despite Chinese (and Indian) warnings, and "further complications ensued."[210] With the resolution, it was only shutting the door to negotiations and compounding its mistakes.[211]

Truman disagreed, and bluntly and publicly said, "I believe in calling an aggressor an aggressor."[212] American commentators dismissed Nehru's assertion that the isolation of China, rather than Chinese aggression, had led to the situation in Korea. Worse, he was playing into Chinese hands by "sowing confusion and mistrust."[213] Beijing did not want a settlement, as Delhi and London believed. Rather, Chinese actions were designed to divide the noncommunist countries.[214]